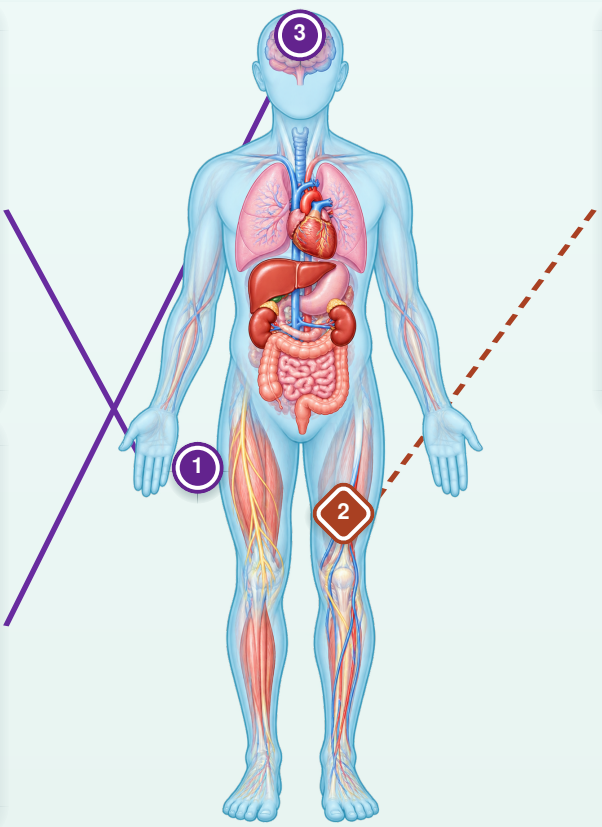
Weekly paclitaxel

Paclitaxel on Days 1, 8, 15 and 22 of a 28-day cycle; a Days 1, 8 and 15 schedule may be selected by the consultant. Confirm your appointment plan.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.



1 Hands / feet

Paclitaxel

Report numbness or tingling before the next dose.

2 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy phase

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: call immediately.

3 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy phase

Hair loss is common. Ask about scalp cooling before treatment where suitable.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Selected medicine-specific effects; the full risk discussion includes hair loss, fertility and other individual risks.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts / infection
- Sensory or motor neuropathy, potentially persistent
- Hypersensitivity / infusion reaction
- Hair loss and nail / skin changes
- Muscle and joint aches
- Fatigue and mouth / bowel symptoms
- Rare serious lung or cardiac effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Premedication for infusion reactions

Steroid and antihistamine premedication reduce the chance or severity of reactions. The team may adjust premedication after tolerated doses. Do not omit or change it yourself; tell the nurse about missed doses.

Aches, nausea and bowel support

Agree a pain-relief and anti-sickness plan. Ask before taking new medicines. Uncontrolled pain or poor intake needs review. Some supportive medicines cause constipation or drowsiness.

Nerve symptoms and fall prevention

Use secure footwear and take care with balance, hot surfaces and sharp objects if sensation is reduced. Tell the team early about functional changes; persistent neuropathy may influence dosing.

Hair, nails and skin

Ask about hair-loss support and whether scalp cooling is appropriate and available. Protect sensitive nails and skin. Report painful nail changes, spreading rash, blistering or infection.

Review the full medicine plan

First-dose NCCP suggested premedication: dexamethasone 8 mg intravenous (IV), chlorphenamine 10 mg IV and famotidine 20 mg IV 30 minutes before paclitaxel. From Day 8, dexamethasone may be omitted in the source suggested table; add or modify for increased risk or previous reaction under consultant guidance. Famotidine omission is also a consultant/local-policy decision requiring close observation. The conventional paclitaxel product information has a different generic premedication regimen. Reconcile the exact product, weekly NCCP pathway and local policy; never self-omit premedication. Low emetic risk; keep the antiemetic plan separate from reaction premedication. Consider analgesia for myalgia/arthralgia and early action on neuropathy.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00226/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.